

Chapel Hill Friends Meeting

Newsletter: Ninth Month, 2026



Monthly Query: *How do I experience our Meeting as a beloved community?*

Monthly Worship Tip from the M&W Committee: *When taking in another's vocal ministry, take a moment to test your own reactions. Where do they come from? Are you listening through to the Light behind the message? If you find yourself struggling with another's words, search for the Love behind them.*

Contents

Monthly Calendar	1
Upcoming Zoom Fora	2
Upcoming Events	2
Free Shared Learning Liberman Lecture, Fri. Sept. 11, 11:15 am	2
Invitation to a Really Silent Meeting in Minneapolis, Sept. 16-20	3
Clerks' Workshop, Sat. Sept. 26, 8:45 am	4
Memorial for Maria Darlington Sat. Sept. 26, 2 pm	4
Celebration of Life for Jim Palmer, Sun. Oct. 11, 2 pm	4
Important Announcement	5
Bequests to the Chapel Hill Friends Meeting	5
Announcements	5
Piedmont Friends Events for September	5
"Dance Meditations" at Durham Friends, 2 Saturdays/month 4-6 pm	5
Celebrating Quaker Belief and Practice at CFS	6
Quaker House Hotline is Increasingly Active	7
Personals	7
Home for Sale	7
Recurring Announcements	8
InterFaith Council Committee Is Seeking Volunteers	8
Zoom Tech Hosts Wanted	8
Inter-Faith Council Pantry Needs Donated Food Items	9

FRIENDS, PLEASE LIMIT YOUR WEEKDAY MEETINGHOUSE VISITS.	9
Newsletter & eNews Reminder	9
Recurring Events	10
Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light, 2nd and 4th Wednesday, 7-8:30 pm	10
Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace in Palestine. Thursdays, 5:30pm	10
Pendle Hill Worship via Zoom, Daily, 8:30-9:10am	10
Pray for Peace - From Friends House Moscow, Daily	11
Business Meeting Minutes	11
Appendix A: Gordon Davies Memorial Minute	14
Appendix B: Perry Martin Memorial Minute	15
Appendix C: Richard Crockett Miller Memorial Minute	16



Monthly Calendar

First Sunday	8:15 - 9:15 am - Early worship in the meeting room 9:30 - 10:30 am - Forum via Zoom 11:00 am - 12:00 - Worship in the meeting room 11:00 am - 12:00 - Online worship via Zoom - After meeting - Potluck in the schoolhouse
Second Sunday	8:15 - 9:15 am - Early worship in the meeting room 9:30 - 10:30 am - Forum via Zoom 11:00 am - 12:00 - Blended Meeting in the meeting room and via Zoom
Third Sunday	8:00 - 9:00 am - Early worship in the meeting room (reverts to 8:15 the following week) 9:00 - 10:30 am - Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business via Zoom 11:00 am - 12:00 - Worship in the meeting room 11:00 am - 12:00 - Online worship via Zoom
Fourth Sunday	Same as Second Sunday - Blended Meeting
Fifth Sunday	Same as First Sunday, but without potluck



Upcoming Zoom Fora

<https://www.chapelhillfriends.org/forums.html>

- September 6:** Sharing Forum on “Bias”
Presented by the Racial Reconciliation Subcommittee (formerly the Racial Equity Subcommittee), the forum will be a sharing format along the same lines as the Summer Series, focusing on the word “bias”
- September 13:** Presentation from Re-Entry House Plus
- September 20:** Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business - No forum
- September 27:** TBD
-



Upcoming Events

Free Shared Learning Liberman Lecture, Fri. Sept. 11, 11:15 am

Asta Crowe shares with Friends:

The Science of the Good Samaritan: Epidemiology, Equity, and Empathy

Prof. Emily Smith, Duke University

Free and open to the public

Fellowship Hall, Church of Reconciliation

110 North Elliott Rd, Chapel Hill

Dr. Emily Smith is Associate Professor in the Department of Emergency Medicine/Surgery at Duke University and Associate Professor of Global Health at the Duke Global Health Institute. Her research interests include the intersection of poverty and global children’s health in low-income countries.

In this presentation, Dr. Smith explores what it means to love your neighbor in today’s fraught, divided world. The story of the Good Samaritan is one that many of us know by heart, with the concept of love-thy-neighbor transcending religion, social class, and where you live. However, acting like the Good Samaritan is costly and requires courage, tenacity, and a re-orientation of

our worldviews. This presentation will dive into what loving our neighbors truly means – even when it comes at a cost. Because on the other side of cost is courageous empathy that changes us into better neighbors.

This event is free and open to the public. However, since there is limited seating available in Fellowship Hall, advanced registration is required for Shared Learning members as well as the general public. You can easily register (one individual) by clicking on [this link](https://sharedlearning.us) or by visiting <https://sharedlearning.us> and navigating to the Liberman Lectures tab. Early registration is encouraged.

Invitation to a Really Silent Meeting in Minneapolis, Sept. 16-20

Sam Leeman-Munk shares with Friends:

On Thursday, September 17th at 11:00 AM, I've arranged an hour of worship inside the anechoic chamber at Orfield Laboratories in Minneapolis — the quietest room in North America, so quiet you can hear your own heartbeat. A room like that ought to hold a meeting for worship at least once, and now it will: a really silent meeting.

For Friends traveling with me, the shape of the trip is a short retreat:

- **Wednesday, Sept 16** — Fly into Minneapolis. Easy afternoon; I'm planning a walk to Minnehaha Falls, a 53-foot waterfall inside the city.
- **Thursday, Sept 17** — Worship in the chamber at 11:00, then lunch together at Matt's Bar, home of a Minneapolis institution called the Jucy Lucy (ask me).
- **Friday, Sept 18** — A day trip to Lake Superior's North Shore: Gooseberry Falls, Split Rock Lighthouse, and the closest thing the Midwest has to an ocean. Friends could fly home Friday night or Saturday.
- **Sunday, Sept 20** (optional extension) — I'll be worshipping with Minneapolis Friends Meeting at 10:00 AM and would love company; note that Saturday I'm at the wedding that occasioned this trip, so Friends staying through the weekend would have that day to themselves.

What I'm providing: the chamber session and the driving — airport runs, the waterfall, the North Shore, and Sunday's meeting for those who stay.

What travelers would cover: flights to MSP, lodging, and meals. I'm staying at the Country Inn & Suites in Brooklyn Center; you're welcome to book there too or stay wherever suits you.

9The chamber holds six worshippers, and four spots remain — so if you're interested, even tentatively, **please reply by August 2nd**, and I'll hold seats in the order Friends write.

And come for whatever calls to you — the chamber, the lake, or both. Every piece of this trip is optional; the silence at the center of it is merely the occasion.

In peace,
Sam Leeman-Munk

Clerks' Workshop, Sat. Sept. 26, 8:45 am

in person at the school building. At least one person from each committee would be valuable for all.

Memorial for Maria Darlington Sat. Sept. 26, 2 pm

Maria Darlington was an attender at Chapel Hill Friends and Eno Friends Meeting. She died in July of this year <https://obits.endswellfuneralhome.com/maria-darlington>.

Her memorial service is scheduled for Saturday, September 26th at 2 p.m. at our Meeting House with Eno Friends Meeting as a co-sponsor.

Celebration of Life for Jim Palmer, Sun. Oct. 11, 2 pm

The celebration of the life of our Friend Jim Palmer will take place on Sunday October 11, at 2:00 pm in River Park, Hillsborough. The celebration will be followed by a reception at the Farmer's Market pavilion at the park. All are invited. Please continue to hold Jim's family and friends in the Light.



Important Announcement

Bequests to the Chapel Hill Friends Meeting



You have very likely heard pitches on PBS or other charitable organizations asking you to include them in your estate plans. The Finance committee wants to remind folks that you can do the same thing for our Meeting!

In one sentence: bequests to Chapel Hill Friends Meeting can make a real difference in the life of our Meeting and to its financial security.

We encourage you to read the Finance Committee's complete [estate planning guide](#).



Announcements

Piedmont Friends Events for September

<https://www.piedmontfriends.org/piedmont-friends-monthly-events/>

“Dance Meditations” at Durham Friends, 2 Saturdays/month 4-6 pm

This is Jack Wolf from Eno Friends in Hillsborough.

We have had a number of what I am calling Dance Meditations, in the Fellowship Room at Durham Friends Meeting, on various Saturday Afternoons from 4-6 PM.

At this writing, if you get this in time our next dance is August 29 and we will have dances on Sept 12 and 26, October 3 and 31 and November 14 and 28.

I, Jack Wolf, am a member of Eno Friends in Hillsborough, am organizing these along with Richard Jerram from Eno Friends, and Laura Aliberti.

We charge no money for these events but accept contributions only to cover the rent.

These dances are in the manner of what is often referred to as Ecstatic Dance or Dance Waves which I will describe below. I chose the term Dance Meditation because Ecstasy is a high bar, and a more modest goal of being spiritually inspired or just having fun while burning calories might suffice for a humble Quaker.

For those new to this form of dance:

Our dances are 90 minutes of improvisational unstructured dance to recorded music designed to create a deep free experience. There is no particular step or skill needed, just a chance to move the body and free the mind. People should abstain from conversation during the dance. Chairs will be there and one need not exert beyond your level of comfort and ability so we do encourage those with limited mobility to attend.

These types of dances occur internationally and were largely inspired by the late Gabrielle Roth and her 5 Rhythms concept (<https://www.5rhythms.com/>), though it will be up to the designer of each set and the dancers how strictly they wish to adhere to 5 Rhythms concepts. It can be a useful model. Richard Jerram, one of our organizers, has taught 5 Rhythms in both the UK and US for decades. We hope to see you, any questions call Jack 919-245-8393 jackhwolf49@gmail.com.

Celebrating Quaker Belief and Practice at CFS

Good morning, Friends,

I serve as the Staff Clerk at Carolina Friends School. I wanted to share this newsletter with you all. It celebrates some of the many ways that Quaker belief and practice make their way into the everyday life of the school.

The newsletter's original intended audience was staff at CFS, but Karen (our head of school) and I realized our local Friends might enjoy reading about how our Quaker roots live here at school. So here it is! The 27-27 school year first edition of [Celebrating Quaker Belief and Practice at CFS](#), a monthly newsletter for Staff, Former Staff, and local Friends Meetings.

In this month's edition you will find:

- August "Tenet of the Month"

- Upper School "orientation slideshow" - Learning with Joy, Purpose and Courage
- Middle School "What does it mean to be a Quaker School" slide show
- Karen's graduation talk about the tension between cultivating peace and seeking truth

Respectfully submitted,
Ida Trisolini

Quaker House Hotline is Increasingly Active

Curt Torell share with Friends:

Steve and Lenore, our Quaker House GI Rights Hotline counselors, already in the first eight months of the year logged as many calls as in all of 2025. Many are seeking conscientious objection discharge. Their latest board report included this news:

"A Dutch reporter called this week wanting to know about current morale and especially if we had calls from people on the USS Abraham Lincoln. We explained that we have had multiple calls from depressed sailors who felt like the medical providers on their ship were ignoring their serious concerns. And at the same time for confidentiality reasons we don't usually ask people for more identifying information than we need to present options. So we don't actually know which ship's crewmembers we helped. But low morale among callers is not limited to one mismanaged ship in the Navy. Many callers share a feeling of no point or purpose in the missions of the current administration. When the president sent troops into US cities we received many calls from servicemembers, veterans, and citizens expressing strong opposition. But there were occasional harassing calls from supporters of the administration admonishing us for our work. Since the war in Iran the harassing calls have stopped completely while we still get the calls from people opposed to the administration. The Iran war seems unpopular even among people who supported the administration's other actions."



Personals

Home for Sale

Allie Scales shares with Friends:

My much loved home in the Kirkwood community is for sale. Two bed, three bathrooms, and lots of bonuses, not least, glorious sunsets, and neighbor to Matt and Lynn Drake! Easy reach of CHFM, and lots of neighborhood amenities.

https://www.zillow.com/homedetails/104-Homewood-Dr-Chapel-Hill-NC-27514/50051796_zpid/





Recurring Announcements

InterFaith Council Committee Is Seeking Volunteers

We invite anyone interested in becoming, or knowing more about being an IFC Committee Member to please contact Carolyn White.

We welcome volunteers to help with food preparation and service at ICF every second Thursday for lunch: 10a - 1p, and/or every second Friday for dinner 4p-6:30p. Volunteers are welcome for part of the shift, or the full shift.

Zoom Tech Hosts Wanted

Support Chapel Hill Friends Meeting's Zoom worship and forums by becoming a tech host. The role is much more simple than you would imagine. Trust us! We need your help and will train you. Please contact the Zoom Subcommittee if interested, or have questions:

zoom@chapelhillfriends.org.

Inter-Faith Council Pantry Needs Donated Food Items

Please consider IFC's needs when doing your shopping. There is a basket in the meetinghouse foyer for food donations. IFC has requested the following food items: coffee, hot chocolate, canned protein, canned pork and beans, canned soup (not vegetable), boxed cereal, cake mixes, instant foods, ramen noodles. Thank you!

FRIENDS, PLEASE LIMIT YOUR WEEKDAY MEETINGHOUSE VISITS.

The CFS Early School teachers, parents and guests have priority use of the meetinghouse parking lot from 7:30 AM to 6:00 PM Monday through Friday throughout the calendar year. If you must visit the meetinghouse during weekday hours, please alert John Hite, the Meetinghouse Resident, at least one day ahead. Email: johnthequaker@gmail.com or call: 919-929-5377.

Newsletter & eNews Reminder

Please send items for the weekly eNews email and the monthly print Newsletter to news@chapelhillfriends.org.

- The deadline for weekly eNews is *Wednesday* 5 pm.
- The deadline for the monthly print Newsletter is on the *last day of the month*.

To unsubscribe, email to news@chapelhillfriends.org with the subject line, Unsubscribe.

Note: If you think that you haven't received your weekly enews or monthly newsletter, it helps to add news@chapelhillfriends.org to your contacts. Otherwise it might go to your Spam folder (and likewise for other chapelhillfriends.org mailing lists such as pfym@chapelhillfriends.org).



Recurring Events

Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light, 2nd and 4th Wednesday, 7-8:30 pm

YOU ARE INVITED TO PARTICIPATE IN Virtual Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light on the 2nd and 4th Wednesday of each month, 7:00 to 8:30 PM. Join us when you can for as long as you wish - from your own home.

Do you have a name or a group of people to add to - or remove from - the list of those we will hold in our hearts and prayers? If so, please send to: prayers@chapelhillfriends.org. The list of names to be held in the Light will be renewed each month. Names must be resubmitted each month to be maintained on the list. We'll send an updated list on Wednesday afternoons. Thank you for joining us!

This virtual prayer service continues under the care of the Care and Counsel Committee and each week, a committee member will collect and post the names that are submitted and will read them aloud during the time of the service.

Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace in Palestine. Thursdays, 5:30pm

You are invited to join Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace in Palestine and Israel at 5:30 p.m. ET / 2:30 p.m. PT.

Join on Zoom:

<https://afsc-org.zoom.us/j/85831333364?pwd=VEtPTUZuYk5hTHV2OGs1VzRkY0ZKUT09>

Meeting ID: 858 3133 3364

Passcode: 759311

Pendle Hill Worship via Zoom, Daily, 8:30-9:10am

Pendle Hill Quaker Study, Retreat, and Conference Center is now opening their daily morning worship to everyone, by way of Zoom or phone. A lovely opportunity for gathered worship every morning. "A handful of Pendle Hill residents continue to gather daily in the Barn – from 8:30am to 9:10am Eastern Time – expanding the 90-year-long tradition of daily worship here on campus. Beginning the week of March 16, 2020, we started an experiment of opening the circle of worship to YOU in your home. You can join us here via Zoom."

<https://pendlehill.org/explore/worship/join-us-online-for-worship-in-the-barn/?bblinkid=210290749&bbemailid=19903873&bbejrid=1408822779>

Note: The above link takes you *not* to the meeting but to a page of general instructions. Look for the sentence "You can join us via Zoom **here**, or by clicking on the image below."

Pray for Peace - From Friends House Moscow, Daily

Link to the Daily Meeting for Worship for Peace sponsored by FHM/FHMSA: (Friends House Moscow)

Join Zoom Meeting

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/4165005614?pwd=NUtieEtqbDBYbjBrcGdMMzBKQ3drQT09>

Meeting ID: 416 500 5614

Passcode: 182805

The room opens at 8:45am Pacific time (10:45 EST); worship begins on the hour and ends an hour later. After worship there will be time to share brief thoughts that did not rise to the level of ministry. You may also want to rename yourself indicating your geographic location. There will be no audible indicator when one enters or leaves, and everyone will be muted on entry. Please leave yourself muted unless giving ministry.

Ministry may also be shared in the chat, but it is not the place for private conversations. If you are new to Quaker unprogrammed worship and wish to talk with someone about it, send a message to the host and someone can join you in a breakout room.



Business Meeting Minutes

Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business, Chapel Hill Friends Meeting Minutes, August 16, 2026, online via Zoom

Attendance: Jennifer Leeman, Jeff Brown, Monteze Snyder, Quaker Harmon, Lynn Wilson, Barry and Lynda MacKichen, Ann Miller, Carolyn Stuart, Lynn and Matt Drake, Melissa Ruof, Traci Hjvelt Sullivan, Tom Ludlow, Jan Hutton, Linda Graham, Lloyd Kramer, Tom Munk, Dottie Heninger, Wendy Michener, Herb Derby, John Hite, Evelyn Fendler-Lee, Campo Larrick, Kevin Smith, Julia Cleaver, Gwynne Pomeroy, Buzz Borchardt, Kate Fitch, Alice Carlton, Dave Curtin, Colleen Fay, Hank Elkins, Paul Munk, Nancy Milio, Walter Hjvelt Sullivan

1. We opened with worship and the query, “How do I demonstrate in my own decision making a concern for ecological, economic, and social justice?”
2. We welcomed Lynn Wilson as a first time attender.
3. The minutes of the June 2026 Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business (MWAB) were approved.
4. Dottie Heninger, ad hoc representative from Care & Counsel Committee, read a memorial minute for Gordon Davies ([Appendix A](#)). We held Gordon and his family and friends in the Light.
5. Dottie Heninger read a memorial minute for Perry Martin. This minute was written by members of a small group of Meeting members that Perry continued to meet with after she moved to Maine ([Appendix B](#)). We held Perry and her family and friends in the Light.
6. Dottie Heninger read a memorial minute for Richard Miller ([Appendix C](#)). We held Richard, his wife Carolyn, and his family and friends in the Light.

Friends accepted all three minutes and minuted their gratitude for Dottie’s heartfelt, spirit-led memorial minutes.

7. On behalf of the Ministry & Worship Committee, Lloyd Kramer presented the following recommendation:

The Ministry and Worship Committee has come to unity in recommending a Nureva sound system with two white wall-mounted speakers (one on each side of the Meeting Room). We are also recommending the purchase of a "pan tilt video camera" to provide a good zoom view of the Meeting room; and we believe a television screen should be mounted above the fireplace for the projection of zoom meeting participants and documents. We also think there should be some kind of curtain that would cover the screen when it is not in use.

The committee's recommendation follows extended consultation with Quaker, Herb, and other members of the Zoom workgroup and builds on feedback from members of the meeting community. Quaker Harmon provided further input on the possible cost. It will cost \$12,000 for the installation of the Nureva system's two speakers, including wiring and other elements. The zoom-in camera will cost about \$2,000. The TV over the fire price will cost about \$3,000 with a cabinet or curtain. Julia Cleaver reported that the Finance Committee reviewed the estimated costs and we have plenty of funds in the Building Renovation Funds to cover these costs. Friends expressed appreciation for the work of all involved. **Friends approved purchase of the equipment described in Ministry & Worship's report, following receipt of a final contract and review by our trustees, who are authorized to sign the final contract. This approval includes both the Nureva system and the additional equipment.**

8. Kate Fitch, Clerk of Adult Religious Education Committee, invited input on continued discussion of blended forums. Based on extended discussions in the committee and input from the meeting community, the Adult Religious Education Committee proposes moving toward a blended format for forums once a tech host is hired. The committee also recommends moving the forum start time from 9:30 to 9:45. Multiple Friends suggested that we keep the start time at 9:30 and take advantage of the time between forum and meeting to continue in worship and/or community. Several mentioned that it takes 30 minutes to get to meeting from online forum; in response, one Friend noted that the goal would be for all forums to be blended. Several Friends noted a desire to attend blended forum and then travel to in-person meeting for worship. The suggestion was made that we separate the question of whether we support having all forums be blended from the question of the forum start time. Concerning forum start time, a fundamental question is whether we want to support people attending forum online and then traveling to be in person for worship. Clarifying the experiences we wish to have is important. Friends also noted challenges with setting up the technology in the 15 minutes between early meeting and forum time. The recommendation was made that Ministry & Worship and Adult Religious Education Committee confer on the question of timing and that this be brought back to MWAB.

9. Announcements: The Clerks' Workshop will be Saturday morning, September 26 at 8:45 AM in person at the school building. At least one person from each committee would be valuable for all.

10. The next Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business is planned for 9:00 AM on September 20, 2026.

11. We closed with worship.

Jeff Brown, Clerk, and Jennifer Leeman, Recording Clerk

Appendix A: Gordon Davies Memorial Minute

August 8, 1938 - April 12, 2026

Gordon and his wife Betsy Brinson arrived in Chapel Hill at Carol Woods Retirement Community in April 2019, just before the COVID pandemic. They soon became attenders at Chapel Hill Friends Meeting, maintaining their memberships in Richmond Virginia Friends Meeting. Gordon's early religious life was as an Episcopalian in New York City. He sang in the choir for which he was paid 25 cents each week.

During the 20-plus years Gordon lived in Virginia, he pursued a career in higher education. He became the Director of the State Council for Higher Education. He also consulted widely for other organizations of higher education. In his off-hours, he was a marathon runner, and rock/mountain climber – in India, Switzerland, and Germany, as well as across the United States. At home, he baked bread and made pesto for his family and friends.

In retirement, Gordon's Quakerism took on an expanded role. He and Betsy spent a year as Quakers in Residence at Wellington, New Zealand's Friends House where they ran the Quaker Center. Later, they lived in Ramallah, Palestine for a year where Gordon taught at Birzeit University while Betsy wrote the history of Ramallah Friends School.

In later retirement after his arrival in Chapel Hill, Gordon eagerly volunteered in Meeting committees: he washed potluck dishes as a member of Hospitality; at IFC, he served monthly meals. At Carol Woods he helped with the Recycle committee's labor.

Wherever Gordon lived, he made himself useful. He was always keenly aware of the needs in the community and across the country. He approached all aspects of his life with energy and commitment. He was a gift, no matter where he was.

Illness curtailed Gordon's life in his last years. Betsy, his children and grandchildren continue to cherish him. We were grateful to know him for a too-brief time at Chapel Hill Friends Meeting.

Appendix B: Perry Martin Memorial Minute

March 12, 1926 – April 25, 2026

Perry Martin died on April 25, 2026, a few weeks after her 100th birthday. She came to Chapel Hill Friends Meeting approximately twenty years ago, accompanying long-time member, Dirk Spruyt. On March 11, 2006, the day before Perry's 80th birthday, they committed to a life together under the care of the Meeting. Over the years, Perry became a Meeting member, served on the Care and Counsel Committee, and led several small groups.

Few of us knew her many accomplishments prior to joining us. Perry raised six children while moving frequently with her first husband, who was a Swedenborgian minister. During that time she completed an undergraduate degree at Radcliffe, an MA in Counseling at Northwestern, and a PhD in Psychology at UCLA. She practiced psychotherapy with individuals, couples and groups and was an accomplished group facilitator.

Perry and Dirk lived in the Arcadia Cohousing Community where she planted beautiful flower gardens and shared Dirk's concern for preserving the environment. They spent summers in Maine at Perry's family cottage on Long Lake. After Dirk's death in 2016, Perry eventually moved from Arcadia to Maine to live with family and then to the renovated, expanded and winterized cottage by the lake. She rejoiced in summers filled with her returning children and their families and swimming in the lake.

Perry continued meeting by Zoom with one small Meeting group. At the end of the gatherings she reminded us to look each other in the eye, a lesson from Dirk. Perry looked forward to death and her reunion with Dirk. She remains a model for those of us who knew her.

Appendix C: Richard Crockett Miller Memorial Minute

July 18, 1940 – June 6, 2026

Richard Miller attended Chapel Hill Friends for many years before becoming a member in November 2023. He first accompanied Carolyn Stuart to Meeting and soon embraced Friends' emphasis on service and contemplative worship. (He was also attracted to her; they were married in the Meeting in 2008!) Richard served the Meeting for many years on the Building and Grounds Committee where he lent his own skills to the multiple tasks of maintaining and improving our property. Beyond committee work, he provided innumerable acts of kindness to individual Meeting members. He was particularly sensitive to the needs of others and intuitively knew just how to respond. Not in a showy way, but in his own quiet manner.

Richard's devoted caring extended to several communities. Most sustained was the 20-year relationship he had with the men at Orange Correctional Center. He befriended the men at Yokefellows on Tuesday evenings, took part in the twice a month writing group, participated in Meeting for Healing, led by Chapel Hill and Eno Friends in Hillsborough, took out numerous men to community events (often attending meeting for worship), and helped men find work and housing when they left OCC. They responded to his steady, gentle presence, one calling him a "quiet giant."

Richard also loved the natural world. Camping, hiking, and generally discovering the joys of the outdoors were his great pleasure. He was confident no matter where the trail led. Occasionally getting lost was part of the adventure. His love of animals, especially dogs, was another enduring interest. He especially admired the work of Eyes, Ears, Nose and Paws, an organization which helps incarcerated men to train service dogs. He loved each of the many cats he and Carolyn shared their home with, bringing him pleasure daily.

He also mightily enjoyed a good meal with friends on the screened porch he built. Listening to jazz and the blues also filled him with joy. Perhaps his early years in Nashville influenced his musical interests. He graduated from Vanderbilt University with a major in psychology. While there he participated in the Model UN program, underscoring his life-long interest in international affairs.

It is difficult to summarize adequately Richard's "Renaissance Man" life. At his memorial service held in the manner of Friends on July 11, 2026, his life was fully present. We celebrated his intellect, his heart, his love for Carolyn and for us all. We remember his quiet loving manner and how we became better in his presence. His spirit continues to live among us. We will hold Richard's beloved Carolyn in the Light.

Chapel Hill Monthly Meeting of the Religious Society of Friends

531 Raleigh Road, Chapel Hill, NC 27514

Resident: John Hite (919) 929-5377